

and start the server. That's it! We have started the server successfully. Now let us switch to the client. The section below describes the steps to be performed on the client.

- 1) First, launch the Synergy application.
- 2) Select the 'Client' check-box, enter the IP address of the Synergy server in the 'Server IP' text-box and click on the 'Start' button.

After establishing the connection, the screen will look like what's shown in Figure 3.

Auto-launching Synergy

Synergy is an awesome utility. By default, we have to launch it explicitly, every time. Wouldn't it be great if Synergy starts automatically when you log in to the system? We can do this too. In this section, we are going to explore auto-launching the Synergy server after logging into a GNOME session.

We can also launch the Synergy GUI application from the command prompt. Just type `synergy` at the command prompt and that's it. To auto-start Synergy, go to *Unity Dash -> Startup Application Preference -> Click on Add button*. This will result in a pop-up message window. In place of the command, type '*absolute path of Synergy*'. In my case, it is `/usr/bin/synergy`. Click the *Add* button to save the configuration.

If you want to use the configuration set-up with 'synergys', use the following instead:

```
synergys --config ~/synergy.conf
```

To auto-launch the client on Windows, go through the MS Windows documentation.

Tips and tricks

Now that we are familiar with Synergy, let us discuss a few tips and tricks that will make our lives easier.

- 1) If we use a static IP for the Synergy server instead of DHCP, we can configure both the Synergy client and the server to auto-start and also establish a connection whenever we log in to a session. This is a one-time procedure; once you have automated this process, you don't have to do anything.
- 2) Using Synergy, we can seamlessly move the cursor from one monitor to another, but sometimes we may want to restrict the cursor to only one monitor—for instance, while playing video games. To achieve this, press the 'Scroll Lock' key, which will restrict the cursor to the present screen. Users who don't have a 'Scroll Lock' key can re-assign the Scroll Lock key by clicking 'Configure Server' and selecting the 'Hotkeys' tab.
- 3) Synergy shares the clipboard between its sessions. For instance, in our case we can copy text from Windows 7 and paste it in Ubuntu and vice-versa. Additionally, we can also drag and drop files between two MS Windows sessions. This feature is available only with the premium edition. To know more details about this, go through

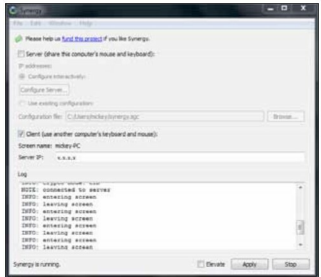


Figure 3: Client

Synergy's official website.

- 4) While copying text between multiple sessions, Synergy automatically translates linefeeds between UNIX and Windows formats, enabling cutting and pasting across systems as easily as within a single one. In addition, it forces screensavers to activate and deactivate, in concert.

Troubleshooting

Sometimes, because of invalid user configuration or software bugs, strange problems do occur. In this section, we are going to discuss a few common issues and how to work around them without spending too much time.

- 1) **Both the Synergy client and servers show that they are in a connected state, but the mouse doesn't appear on the second screen.**

Check whether the 'Scroll Lock' key is activated or not. As stated earlier, the 'Scroll Lock' key restricts the cursor to the current screen. This is the default behaviour of Synergy.

- 2) **Why does the Synergy server refuse to accept a connection to the client?**

This problem may occur because of multiple reasons. First, it can be because of a strict firewall rule. By default, Synergy runs on port number 24800. Check whether a firewall rule is added for that port or not. Additionally, with the '-a' option, we can run it on any other available port.

This issue can also occur because of different client and server versions. Please ensure that both client and server are of the same version. Also, double check the 'aliases' settings.

- 3) **Certain programs stop me from moving the mouse off screen.**

This usually occurs in Windows Vista and later versions, and is due to UAC in Windows. We can get rid of this problem by running Synergy in an 'Elevated' mode. This option is available at the bottom of the main Synergy window.

- 4) **Why is the mouse over sensitive during games on the client?**

To solve this issue, we first need to enable the relative